

TUESDAY

JESUS WELCOMES WOMEN AND MEN

**MEMORY
VERSE**

There is neither male nor female; for you are
all one in Christ Jesus. *Galatians 3:28 NKJV*

INTRODUCTION CREATED FOR EQUALITY

God created Adam and Eve in His image, to be equal partners in marriage and in caring for the garden. Sin disrupted God's original design for male and female equality, and distorted God's original design. God even described Himself using maternal metaphors (Isa. 42:14), as a comforting (Isa. 66:13), and nursing mother (Hos. 11:4).

God provided care and miracles for women who were being abused, or who had experienced difficulties or tragedies. When Jesus came to earth, He was very careful to be kind, protective and uplifting of women, to help restore the imbalanced relationship.

Jesus had male and female followers, and Joanna provided money for his ministry. In the early church men and women worked together to spread the gospel. Men and women, girls, and boys, are given special gifts by the Holy Spirit, and each of us is called to use the gifts we have been given, to bless our families, churches and communities.

Jesus loves everyone, whether they are man or woman, girl, or boy. We are all made in His image, and everyone who loves God can help other people to see something about God through the way that they love other people, regardless of their gender.

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Read together the
story of Nicodemus
and the Samaritan
woman: John
chapters 3 & 4

John tells us two stories about a man and a woman who spoke with Jesus. They were very different people! Nicodemus was a rich, educated, Jewish man, who was highly respected in his community. He didn't want anyone to know that he was meeting Jesus, so he came to talk to Jesus secretly, at night, when it was dark. He had big questions and Jesus told him that he needed to be born again and start learning about God as openly and freely as a child. Nicodemus believed in Jesus, but he didn't have the courage to speak out and stand up for him until after he was crucified.

We don't know the woman's name. But Jesus walked many miles out of His way to meet her in the middle of the day by the village well near Sychar in Samaria. She was

probably a poor woman who had never been to school. She had been married to five husbands, and she wasn't married to the man she was living with. So, the local people gossiped about her and she was sad and lonely.

Most Jewish people didn't want to talk to Samaritans or even be near them! But Jesus simply asked her for a cup of water, to show that He accepted and respected her. Jesus knew everything about her past life, and He didn't criticize her. Jesus was kind and gentle, and He even told her that He was the

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Messiah that she had been looking for and hoping for!

She believed Him immediately, and she ran to the village to tell everyone else to come and meet Him! She wasn't worried about what people thought about her! And she became a wonderful evangelist!

Jesus healed men, women, girls, and boys. He treated each of them with respect and love. He protected the women who felt afraid, and He stopped men from bullying them. He told the woman who poured

perfume over His feet that the beautiful story of her loving and extravagant gift would be told wherever the gospel was shared.

Jesus ministered to men and women. He had 12 disciples, but there were several women who travelled with them and supported Jesus with their money, care, love, and prayers. When Jesus was crucified on the cross, only John had the courage to stay with Jesus, and the rest of the disciples ran away. But there were at least five women who remained with Jesus till He died. And, when He rose again, the first person He spoke to was Mary Magdalene.

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MEMORY VERSE ACTIVITIES

- Fold paper in a concertina and cut 2 chains of paper dolls shaped like women, and 2 chains shaped like men.
- Cut them apart.
- Lay them out in a row, alternating the shapes.
- Write each word of the verse on a different doll in the chain, until you have completed the verse.
- Shuffle the dolls and arrange the words in the correct order.

PRAAYER ACTIVITIES

PRAAYER FOR MALES AND FEMALES

- Talk together about the different needs of males and females in your culture at the different stages of their lives.
- Make a list of their special prayer needs as babies, young children, schoolchildren, teens, young people, in their marriages, in their parenting, midlife and retirement/grandparenting.
- Pray for each gender in turn focusing on their different needs.

BLESSING EACH OTHER

- Ask the males in the family to bless the females and then invite the females to bless the males.
- Proverbs 31:10-31 is a powerful poem of blessing for a wife/ woman that encompasses many of the different things different women do, from caring for the home, family, and even running their own business.

FAMILY ACTIVITIES

CHALLENGING STEREOTYPES

- We all carry gendered stereotypes in our thoughts, without being aware of them.
- Cut 8-10 pictures of different men and women from magazines. Lay them on a table and give each one a different name.
- Make a list of different jobs, interests and hobbies that are common in your culture. Copy one list per person, cut the words apart and give each person a set of words.
- Ask each person to look at the words they have been given, and the pictures on the table, and choose which person is most likely to suit this job, interest, or hobby.
- Invite them to place the words face down next to the person they have chosen, so that none can see the words.
- When everyone has placed all their words on the table, turn them over and discover what each person has chosen.
- Discuss your findings together. Were people more likely to choose a man to be a doctor or a pilot, and woman to be a nurse or a teacher? What about the hobbies? Some men like to paint pictures and some women like to be athletes...What has shaped our ideas about what men and women are supposed to do?
- The Holy Spirit gifts each of God's followers with special skills regardless of their gender.

HEROES AND HEROINES

- Provide paper and coloring/drawing materials.
- Ask each person to choose one male and one female character from the Bible, and to draw their pictures or write each of their names in the center of a separate sheet of paper.
- Pass the pictures around the family and ask each person to write one of the Bible character's spiritual gifts, talents, or character strengths around the edge of the page.
- We can all learn many good things from the brave, wise and loving examples of the heroes and heroines of the Bible.

TUESDAY SNAPSHOT!

THE VERSE

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Galatians 3:28 NKJV

THE INTRODUCTION

Men and women, girls, and boys, are given special gifts by the Holy Spirit, and each of us is called to use the gifts we have been given, to bless our families, churches and communities.

THE DEVOTIONAL

Jesus healed men, women, girls, and boys. He treated each of them with respect and love. He protected the women who felt afraid, and He stopped men from bullying them.

THE PRAYER

Thank God for His original design of male and female equality. Ask for help to love others regardless of their gender.

THE CONVERSATION

Share ideas with each other on how to provide encouragement and support in everyday life as a male or female, so everyone can feel safe within the family.